

Morandi ADHD-Friendly Notes Template

Calm colours, clear chunks, and key points you can spot at a glance

Your Name | September 27, 2026 | Reading time: about 5 minutes

TL;DR This template uses **soft Morandi colours** to reduce visual fatigue, and **consistent colour meanings** plus **short paragraphs** to help you stay focused.

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1 Why ADHD-Friendly Layout?

Goals

- ☐ Understand the design principles behind this template
- ☐ Know what each coloured box means
- ☐ Start writing your own notes with it

For readers whose attention drifts easily, a dense wall of text is often abandoned after three lines. This template breaks a document into **small chunks**, each with its own clear colour and title.

Key Point

One paragraph, one idea. Short paragraphs and generous white space make it easy to read one chunk, pause, and move on to the next.

1.1 Design Principles

- **Muted colours:** Morandi tones are greyed down, so they never compete for attention.
- **Off-white page, dark grey text:** gentler than pure black on pure white.
- **Generous line spacing, left-aligned:** no uneven word gaps, fewer skipped lines.
- **Reading progress bar:** the green bar in the footer shows how much is left.
 - Knowing where the finish line is makes long documents less daunting.



Take a short break, then keep going

2 Colour Meanings at a Glance

Every box type always uses the same colour, so after a while your brain recognises it automatically instead of re-reading the label each time.

Definition: Morandi colours

Named after the Italian painter Giorgio Morandi, whose still lifes use colours mixed with grey, giving low-saturation, calm tones.

Example

- 1 Open `main-en.tex`
- 2 Replace the title and author with your own
- 3 Build with `latexmk main-en.tex`

Tip

Use `\key{...}` for key terms, `\hl{...}` as a highlighter, and `\soft{...}` for side notes (like this one).

Caution

This template must be compiled with **XeLaTeX**; pdfLaTeX cannot load the system fonts.

Think About It

Without scrolling back: what does a box with a green edge stand for?

2.1 Boxes for Handouts

Big Idea

If you remember only one thing from this chapter, remember what is in this box.

Key Terms

Morandi colour: a low-saturation colour mixed with grey.

Palette: a fixed set of colours used together, defined in `morandi.sty`.

Derivation: Area of a triangle

A rectangle has area $\text{base} \times \text{height}$; a triangle is half of the rectangle with the same base and height, so $A = \frac{1}{2}bh$.

Self-Check

- ☐ I can explain the difference between a key-point box and a definition box
- ☐ I know answer letters are marked with `\answer{B}`, e.g. answer: **B**

2.2 Tables

Environment	Colour	Purpose
keypoint	Sage mdSage	Key point
definition	Dried rose mdTerm	Definition
example	Grey blue mdBlue	Worked example
goals	Deep blue mdDeep	Goals
tip	Milk tea mdSand	Tip
warning	Light rose mdRose	Caution
question	Warm grey mdMuted	Think about it
terms	Milk tea mdSand	Key terms

2.3 Reading Guide

Wrap a paragraph in `\bionic{...}` and the first two letters of every third word are set in bold, giving your eyes regular anchor points as they move along the line:

Reading long paragraphs **can** be exhausting **when** attention keeps **drifting** away from **the** page. Small **visual** anchors spaced **evenly** along each **line** give the **eyes** somewhere to **land**, which makes **it** easier to **keep** your place **and** carry on **reading**.

Adjust the pattern with `\bionicsetup{every=3, letters=2}`.

Nice work! Just one section to go

3 Maths Works Too

Inline maths such as $E = mc^2$, or displayed equations:

$$\int_0^1 x^2 dx = \frac{1}{3}$$

Recap

- ✓ Colours tell you what kind of information you are reading
- ✓ Short paragraphs with plenty of white space
- ✓ A progress bar to keep long documents manageable
- ☐ Start writing your own notes!